

GLOBE ARTICHOKE *Cynara scolymus*

The succulent petal bases and centers of tender, immature globe artichoke flowers are delicious boiled, while young shoots can be blanched for use in salads. When grown from seed, globe artichokes can be variable in quality, so, if possible, purchase named offsets that have been propagated. It is also possible to select from the best of your seed-raised plants to produce a good quality offset.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Give globe artichokes a sheltered but sunny position. They do best in well-drained, fertile, moisture-retentive soil, so dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost before planting and apply some balanced fertilizer.

In spring, sow seed in pots indoors, or in outdoor seedbeds, at a depth of 2 in (5 cm). The young seedlings should be transplanted to their final positions in early summer.

Offsets taken in spring from the sides of mature plants are a better way of raising new plants if good quality mother plants are available. Offsets are also sold by specialty nurseries. Ensure that plants have enough space, allowing 30 in (75 cm) between



Apply a compost mulch every spring.

plants and 36 in (90 cm) between rows. Push offsets deep enough into the soil that they can stand upright, then water in well.

CROP CARE

Keep plants free of weeds and apply plenty of water in dry spells. Apply fertilizer and an organic mulch every spring. In the fall, plants die back and the dead material should be removed.